

i-HUB GUJARAT

IGNITING INNOVATION, EMPOWERING STARTUPS

Driving Gujarat's emergence as India's most vibrant startup hub, i-Hub's 'Mind-to-Market' philosophy is fostering a resilient and inclusive entrepreneurial ecosystem— aligned with the vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047.

At the heart of Gujarat's thriving innovation landscape lies i-Hub Gujarat, a flagship initiative that is shaping one of India's startup ecosystem success stories. Established on May 16, 2019, by the Education Department, Government of Gujarat under the Student Startup and Innovation Policy (SSIP), i-Hub is a transformational platform turning ideas into scalable enterprises.

Anchored in the Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 2016 vision to boost a national startup movement, and powered by the Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel's leadership, Gujarat became the first state to institutionalise innovation and incubation centres across its government and private universities. Incorporated as a not-for-profit Section 8 company, i-Hub serves as a centralised enabler of the state's innovation ecosystem providing a single-window support system. Its 'Mind-to-Market' philosophy is catalysing a new generation of job creators, across Gujarat's academic landscape.

The cutting-edge infrastructure at i-Hub Gujarat established in Ahmedabad is a 1.5 lakh sq. ft. plug-and-play facility inaugurated by the Chief Minister of Gujarat in December 2023. It can host up to 500 startups, equipped with advanced, meeting rooms, auditorium, mentor spaces, and co-working infrastructure. Within just one year of its inauguration, 80% co-working space have been allocated to early and growth-stage startups.

Exemplary Startup ecosystem Leadership

As of 2025, Gujarat is home to around 14,000 DPIIT (Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade) recognised startups, remarkably, around 6,300 of these are women-led ventures or led by women entrepreneurs, showcasing the state's commitment to inclusive and gender-balanced innovation ecosystem.



Through a comprehensive support system including early-stage grant funding, sector-specific acceleration programs, state and national-level exhibitions, testing and validation facilities, IP support, mentorship from various domain experts, and private investment facilitation for growth-stage startups i-Hub is supporting Gujarat's youth with the tools, networks, and resources to thrive as next-generation entrepreneurs.

Flagship Initiatives by i-Hub Gujarat

i-Hub Gujarat offers a comprehensive suite of flagship initiatives designed to support startups at every stage of their entrepreneurial journey from ideation and validation to scaling and investment facilitation process. Programs like **Startup Saathi** connect startups with experienced mentors across sectors, while **Startup Saksham** focuses on strengthening the capabilities of startups and ecosystem enablers through targeted training. **Startup Samajh** provides incentives for startups and innovators to participate in national and international innovation events. **Startup Engage** enables direct interaction between startups and senior government officials, allowing for greater visibility and policy feedback. **Startup Clinic** links startups with domain experts and service providers to address specific operational challenges, and **Startup Square** fosters industry-startup collaboration through joint problem-solving and prototyping. Through **Startup Srujan**, i-Hub offers financial grants up to ₹10 lakh to develop Proof of Concept (PoC) and Minimum Viable Products (MVP). **Startup Grow** provides incubation space and infrastructure support for early and